

Great Value — LSO Runbook

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Mindset

GV is 'always outnumbered by big things, never out-graunched by small ones.' You are the DURABLE, STICKY, all-comers list — you rarely get tabled and rarely get out-scored. Play the OATH like a sniper (one perfect target/turn), weather the enemy's alpha behind 2+/4++ (Armour of Contempt helps only vs AP-1/-2 volume, NOT railguns/fusion/Dev), and win the LONG GAME on sticky objectives + attrition. Your THREE failure modes: (1) getting out-BODIED/out-OC'd by a true horde, (2) getting out-MANOEUVRED and out-scored by a faster army while your M5 bricks are stranded, and (3) getting BATTLE-SHOCKED by a shock-weaponizer (Tyranids/CSM/Necrons/Daemons) -> the OC34 brick drops to OC0 and its defensive strats switch off. Deploy your homers to control WHERE the alpha lands; hold 1 CP for Insane Bravery vs shock decks; never waste the Oath on a target you can't finish.

Weighted ~50%. 'Great Value' is a durable Purge gunline: it FEASTS on Priority-Assets armies (Destroyer's Wrath kill-mission) and out-lasts most, but the true horde out-bodies it (the one hole).

Tapestry quick-reference

Rule	What it does
Oath of Moment (THE engine)	Each Command phase name ONE enemy unit -> the whole army re-rolls Hits AND (mono-IF) adds +1 to Wound into it. ~DOUBLES every unit's damage onto the Oathed target. Convergence, not raw guns, is how GV kills.
The OC34 brick (Inspiring Commander + Astartes Banner)	TWO stacked buffs, verified from the pack: (1) Lysander's Inspiring Commander SETS non-Character Terminators to OC2 in EVERY Terminator squad army-wide; (2) the Ancient's Astartes Banner adds +1 OC to EVERY model in the Ancient's OWN unit (Terminators, Lysander AND the Ancient). Net for the Lysander brick: 10 Terminators at OC3 (=30) + Lysander OC2 + Ancient OC2 = OC34 WHILE INTACT. (The separate cyclone Terminator brick gets the OC2 from Inspiring Commander but NOT the banner -> ~OC21, itself a heavy scorer.) (We previously undercounted this as OC22 by missing the banner.) It won't take a Command-phase battle-shock test until below half strength (6+ dead), so vs most armies the OC34 holds. But NO battle-shock immunity: a FORCED test (see Battle-shock entry) shocks it at full strength -> OC drops to '-' (0), and Inspiring Commander explicitly stops working while Battle-shocked -> all 34 evaporates at once.
Wrath of Dorn (Emperor's Shield)	Re-roll a Wound-roll of 1 army-wide + FULL wound re-roll for Lysander's unit. Stacks with Oath.
Armour of Contempt	-1 AP to incoming attacks (stratagem). Drops enemy AP-2 -> AP-1; brutal vs AP-1/-2 VOLUME (the common case). BUT does NOTHING vs AP-4/-5 (armour already negated) or

(defence)	whenever you're taking an INVULN save (AP never modifies an invuln), and NOTHING vs Devastating/mortal wounds -- so it does not save you from railguns/fusion/Dev spikes.
Sternguard Focus (unsaveable)	vs the Oathed unit, Sternguard get FULL wound re-roll -> every crit-6 = a Devastating mortal wound. ~5-7 mortals/turn that skip ANY invuln/Ion Shield. Their teleport-arrival turn is their WEAKEST shoot.
Teleport / Deep-Strike engines	THREE arrival threats: Sternguard teleport (Temporal Corridor), Land Speeder Deep Strike, Teleport-Homer jumps (Vanguard/Bladeguard). Reserve-heavy hidden alpha lands turn 2 within homer range.
Librarius Conclave	Each round pick 1 Discipline; ALL friendly ADEPTUS ASTARTES PSYKER units get it until end of round (that's the Librarian-led Sternguard + the Librarian-in-Term cyclone brick — NOT the Lysander brick, it has no psyker). Verified from the pack: Biomancy = +2" M / Divination = re-roll Hit-1s AND Wound-1s / Pyromancy = +1 AP vs enemies within 12" / Telekinesis = -1 S to ranged attacks INTO the unit (defensive) / Telepathy = ignore BS/WS/hit-roll modifiers. Fusillade Enhancement makes the bearer's ranged attacks [LETHAL HITS], +[SUSTAINED HITS 1] if the unit also has Pyromancy. Typical pick: Pyromancy (turns the cyclone brick into +1 AP + Lethal + Sustained into the Oath target) or Divination for reliability.
The alpha math	Full-stack into an Oathed target ~30-34 (10+ unsaveable Sternguard Dev); the Lysander brick (full Wrath re-roll + Oath) ~49 melee -> one-rounds ANY single model, even a 4++.
The soft underbelly	Everything hangs on the SOFT LEGS (Sternguard, Land Speeders, cyclone Termies, Vanguard) + the 2 SLOW M5 bricks. Kill the legs -> the convergence collapses; out-mobile the bricks -> the board opens.
Killing characters (NO Precision)	Sternguard/cyclone/brick have NO [PRECISION] -> you canNOT snipe a Character attached to a Bodyguard unit (wounds hit the bodyguard). Tools: (1) grind the whole unit down with Oath volume, exposing the char; (2) EPIC CHALLENGE (core strat 15.03, 1CP) -> Lysander's Fist gains [PRECISION] to assassinate an ATTACHED char in MELEE; (3) STANDALONE Monster/Titanic chars (Fulgrim/Magnus/Lion/superheavy) = shoot DIRECTLY. Oath the UNIT, not the character.
CP economy (~2/round)	1 CP at the start of EACH player-turn (~10/game) + CP-model/discard extras. Oath of Moment is FREE (army rule). BUT Armour of Contempt, Fury of the First, Disciplined Extermination, Dropship Extraction, Wrathful Conquerors AND Epic Challenge all COMPETE for ~1 strat/turn -> you cannot fire them all. Each turn pick ONE priority: the offence convergence strat, OR defensive AoC, OR Epic Challenge -- and hold CP for the swing turns.
Battle-shock — GV's HIDDEN weakness	Core 01.07: a battle-shocked unit has OC '-' (0), CANNOT be targeted by ANY stratagem, and cannot do/finish Actions. GV's ENTIRE win-con is the OC34 brick out-scoring you on objectives -> shock it and that collapses, AND you shut off his defensive strats on it (no AoC/Rotate-equivalent on a shocked unit). Lysander gives NO immunity. His mitigations: Insane Bravery (core 15.04, 1CP, auto-pass ONE test -> competes for the same CP as everything else) and staying above half strength (no voluntary test). WEAPONIZERS to expect at LSO that FORCE tests at full strength: Tyranids (Shadow in the Warp = -1 Ld / forced tests near synapse), CSM (Dread Talons / Fear-based -1 & forced), Necrons (forced-test tech), Chaos Daemons (terror/forced). Against those decks the OC34 is NOT reliable -- plan for it to drop to OC0 on a bad round.
Core strats cut	Every army at LSO has the same 12 core stratagems (Section 15): Command Re-roll,

BOTH ways Counter-offensive, Epic Challenge, Insane Bravery, Grenade, Tank Shock, Fire Overwatch, Smokescreen, Heroic Intervention, Rapid Ingress, Go to Ground, Armour of Contempt. So the OPPONENT can Epic-Challenge to snipe GV's characters in melee too, Counter-offensive to fight first, Rapid Ingress to steal the alpha, and Fire Overwatch the teleport drop. GV isn't the only one with these tricks -- budget CP for the enemy's core plays, not just your own.

Per-matchup battle plans (10 archetypes)

Emperor's Children — 58% (Lean favourable) · you play **Meatgrinder** vs their **Purge the Foe** (they play **Meatgrinder**)

Deciding factor: Your 2+/4++ + Armour of Contempt tanks the Infractor/Daemonette melee that shreds W1 armies; Oath + Sternguard Dev delete the Defilers and the Lord Exultants; the brick one-rounds Fulgrim/Keeper if they commit. Their AP-1/-2 volume is the wrong shape for TEQ.

Plan:

- Oath the Defiler each turn (it's the only thing that hurts your armour) — Sternguard Dev + cyclone remove one/turn.
- Let the Daemonette/Infractor chaff crash into the brick; it holds and swings back for ~49. Don't chase.
- Sticky your objectives; grind. They can't out-durable or out-score you — win on attrition.

Watch: Fulgrim (Fights First, -1 to hit) + Maulerfiends can trade into a brick; Oath them before they charge.

Orks — 18% (Unfavourable) · you play **Unstoppable Force** vs their **Take and Hold** (they play **Immovable Object**)

Deciding factor: The ONE army that out-BODIES and out-OCs you. ~100 Boyz + 5++ + power claws flood the board; your OC34 brick holds 1-2 objectives but they blanket the rest, and claws crack even Terminators. Your shooting mows Boyz but can't clear 100.

Plan:

- Do NOT try to out-OC the horde — concede the middle, hold your 2 bricks' objectives + sticky what you can.
- Oath the biggest brick each turn (Ghazghkull's or the klaw-nob unit); shooting-focus to thin the OC where it decides an objective.
- Bricks counter-punch (they survive the claws better than anything); Speeders melta the Kill Rigs/Wazdakka. Race secondaries — you won't out-primary a full horde.

Watch: Getting tar-pitted and out-actioned; Green Tide is a genuine ~45% — accept it and minimise the margin.

Adeptus Mechanicus — 85% (Favourable) · you play **Destroyer's Wrath** vs their **Priority Assets** (they play **Vital Link**)

Deciding factor: Their anti-tank is WASTED on you: Kataphron arc rifle [Anti-Vehicle 4+] and ferrumite do nothing special to INFANTRY, and D6-damage guns over-kill W2-3 bodies. You out-durable (AoC + 2+/4++), out-volume, and Oath deletes a Kataphron brick/turn.

Plan:

- Oath a Kataphron brick each turn — Sternguard Dev + cyclone + Speeder melta erase it (no invuln/FNP).
- Advance into their M5 gunline; Armour of Contempt shrugs the ferrumite/lascannon. Brick eats

Kastelan/Ironstriders in melee.

- Out-score — their bodies are few and fragile once the Kataphrons die.

Watch: Culexus/Callidus sniping your psykers (throttles Conclave); screen the Librarians.

T'au Empire — 44% (Lean unfavourable) · you play **Meatgrinder vs their **Purge the Foe (they play Meatgrinder)****

Deciding factor: Their anti-elite is Railgun AP-5 / heavy rail AP-4 / fusion AP-4 — NO AP-1, so ARMOUR OF CONTEMPT DOES NOTHING here (AP that high already negates armour; an invuln is never modified by AP). You're on the 4++ ALONE (fails half), and the railgun/rail DEVASTATING WOUNDS turn crits into MORTALS that bypass the 4++ too — a markerlit alpha CAN delete the brick. Your edge isn't your saves, it's RESERVES (few T1 targets) + T'au fragility: Oath one-rounds Crisis/Riptides and the brick walks down anything that lingers. Survive the alpha, then out-grind.

Plan:

- Reserve heavy + hide the brick from first-turn rail/fusion LoS — the alpha can't hurt what it can't see. (Don't waste CP on Armour of Contempt vs their AP-4/-5; it does nothing.)
- In YOUR Command phase each turn, Oath the biggest suit unit ON THE BOARD (Sternguard Dev + cyclone + brick erase it). You commit PROACTIVELY — you CANNOT Oath a unit the turn it deep-strikes in (that's the opponent's turn).
- Grind forward; T'au can't out-durable or out-melee you. Kill markerlight Pathfinders to cut the hit-buffs; make them Fire-and-Fade off objectives.

Watch: Railgun/heavy rail are DEVASTATING WOUNDS -> crit MORTALS bypass your 4++, and AP-4/-5 makes armour moot, so a markerlit rail turn chunks the brick. Keep Terminators spread to limit MORTAL-WOUND SPILLOVER — NOT for 'Blast' (the railgun isn't a Blast weapon, and Blast counts MODELS in the unit, not their spacing, so spreading doesn't reduce it).

Necrons — 36% (Unfavourable) · you play **Unstoppable Force vs their **Take and Hold (they play Immovable Object)****

Deciding factor: C'tan durability (4++/-1Dmg/reanim) blunts even your convergence, and they out-OC with reanimating bodies. Your edge: Sternguard Dev MORTALS partly bypass reanimation, and the brick out-fights Wraiths. But you can't table 3 C'tan and they grind objectives.

Plan:

- Oath + Sternguard Dev a C'tan each turn — mortals skip the 4++; you won't kill it but you suppress it.
- Don't feed the brick into the Void Dragon (Anti-Veh, heals off you); brick kills Wraiths/Lychguard instead.
- Win on sticky objectives + secondaries; it's a grind you can steal, not a matchup you dominate.

Watch: Reanimation refunding your chip — focus-remove whole units, don't spread. BATTLE-SHOCK: their 1CP C'tan strat forces the OC34 brick to test at -1 (+D3+1 mortals on fail) -> a failed test zeroes its OC and shuts off its strats on the turn you most need it holding. Hold 1 CP for Insane Bravery when the brick is contesting a key objective.

Adeptus Custodes — 37% (Unfavourable) · you play **Unstoppable Force vs their **Take and Hold (they play Immovable Object)****

Deciding factor: Mirror of elites: their 2+/4++ + better melee weapons vs your 2+/4++ + more bodies + Oath + unsaveable Sternguard. They out-fight the brick model-for-model; you out-number and out-shoot (Dev bypasses their 4++).

Plan:

- Do NOT brawl the Blade Champion/Wardens with the brick head-on — Oath + Sternguard Dev SHOOT them down (mortals skip the 4++).
- Use your body count + sticky OC to out-score; they have ~40 models, you have more.
- Speeders melta the Caladius; cyclone + Oath delete a Custodian unit/turn.

Watch: Trajann/Blade Champion out-duel Lysander AND are ATTACHED (you can't snipe them) — grind the whole unit down with Oath volume, or use EPIC CHALLENGE (1CP) to give Lysander's Fist [PRECISION] and kill the character in melee. Don't feed Lysander in unbuffed.

Blood Angels — 42% (Lean unfavourable) · you play **Unstoppable Force vs their Take and Hold (they play Immovable Object)**

Deciding factor: Glass melee alpha into your armour: Death Company/Sang Guard hit hard on the charge but fold to return fire, and Armour of Contempt + 4++ blunts their AP. Oath + overwatch thin the alpha as it lands; the brick counter-punches.

Plan:

- Screen so the DC/Sang Guard land 9" out and can't reach a T2 charge (overwatch thins them). Then on YOUR turn Oath the landed unit and gun it down — you can't Oath it as it arrives in their turn.
- Weather the charge behind 2+/4++/AoC; the brick one-rounds Dante/Sanguinary Guard back.
- Out-grind — they're fragile once the alpha is spent.

Watch: Lemartes/Priests are ATTACHED to the DC/Sang-Guard (you CANNOT target them) — grind the whole unit down with Oath volume, or Lysander + EPIC CHALLENGE (1CP -> [PRECISION]) to assassinate the buff-char in melee.

Dark Angels — 77% (Favourable) · you play **Destroyer's Wrath vs their Priority Assets (they play Vital Link)**

Deciding factor: Terminator mirror: their Deathwing Knights (4++, mace, Smite of the Watchers) + Lion vs your Lysander brick + Sternguard. Both durable; comes down to Oath efficiency + who out-scores. The Lion out-duels Lysander in melee.

Plan:

- SHOOT the Deathwing down with Oath + Sternguard Dev (mortals skip the 4++) — don't melee the mace brick.
- Race objectives; both armies are slow, so board position + sticky OC decide it.
- Speeders + cyclone delete the Ravenwing speeders / support first.

Watch: The Lion is a STANDALONE Monster (directly targetable) — Oath + shoot him down at range (no Precision needed). Do NOT feed Lysander into him in melee.

Drukhari — 56% (Lean favourable) · you play **Consecrate vs their Reconnaissance (they play Triangulation)**

Deciding factor: Fragile paper into your armour: their dark lances are few and their Lethal/pain tokens are non-Vehicle (do little to TEQ); Armour of Contempt + 4++ tanks the splinter. Oath + volume deletes their transports and infantry wholesale.

Plan:

- Oath a Venom/Ravager or the Incubi each turn — shooting erases their paper.
- Weather the T2 lance alpha behind AoC; brick counter-charges the Incubi/Wyches.
- Their speed can out-maneuvre — hold sticky objectives so they can't just flip the board late.

Watch: Being out-actioned by their mobility; keep your homers/screens tight so they can't backfield-raid.

Astra Militarum — 84% (Favourable) · you play **Destroyer's Wrath** vs their Priority Assets (they play Vital Link)

Deciding factor: Their lascannon/volcano over-kills your W2-3 bodies (D6 into W2 = waste), and their infantry can't out-fight yours. You advance behind AoC, Oath the superheavies (or ignore and out-score), and the brick/Speeders crack the tanks.

Plan:

- Reserve vs the alpha; advance into the gunline (they're static). Oath the Shadowsword/Baneblade or just out-score around it.
- Speeder melta + brick delete a superheavy if it's the win-con; otherwise take objectives their tanks can't hold.
- Sticky OC + body count out-scores a low-model Guard tank list.

Watch: Artillery + Leontus orders can chip. Spread bodies to limit mortal/spillover from the big guns — but note spreading does NOT reduce a [BLAST] weapon's shots (Blast = +1 attack per 5 models IN the target unit, regardless of spacing); to cut Blast you bring smaller units.

The list

Unit	×	Role / wargear	Pts
Terminator Assault Squad (TH/SS)	1 0	+ Darnath Lysander + Ancient in Terminator Armour = the OC34 BRICK. Thunder hammer S8 AP-2 D2 [Dev]; ~24-28 melee one-rounds ANY target. M5, Teleport Homer. NOT battle-shock-immune (see below).	310
Darnath Lysander	1	Warlord. Inspiring Commander SETS non-Character Terminators to OC2 in EVERY Terminator Assault/Terminator Squad in his army (army-wide, not just his unit -> the cyclone brick is OC2-each too). Icon of Obstinacy (-1 to wound at S>=5). Himself OC2 (base 1 + the Ancient's banner). Gives NO battle-shock immunity.	100
Ancient in Terminator Armour	1	Astartes Banner: while leading the unit, +1 OC to EVERY model in it (incl. Lysander + itself) -> Terminators OC3, Lysander & Ancient OC2 -> brick = OC34 while intact. Also keeps the brick fighting on death (re-roll a hit/wound). This banner is the OC we missed.	65
Terminator Squad (2x Cyclone)	1 0	+ Librarian in Terminator Armour [Fusillade]. #1 RANGED threat: krak missile S9 AP-2 + cyclone; Fusillade = Lethal Hits. ~one-shots an Armiger.	320
Librarian in Terminator Armour	1	Leads the cyclone brick; Fusillade (Lethal Hits) + a Conclave Discipline/round.	75
Sternguard	1	+ Librarian [Temporal Corridor]. The UNSAVEABLE chipper: Sternguard bolt rifle	~170

Veteran Squad	0	S4 AP-1 D1 [Dev, RF1] + FULL wound-reroll vs Oath -> ~5-7 mortal wounds/turn skipping any invuln. It CLEARS W1/W2 UNITS wholesale — but has NO Precision, so it can't snipe an attached Character; that's Lysander + Epic Challenge in melee.	*
Librarian	1	Temporal Corridor (move-the-Sternguard reserve/reposition) + a Discipline.	~65*
Land Speeder (Multi-melta)	2	Multi-melta S9 AP-4 D6 [Melta 2], 2 shots ea. Armiger/vehicle killer. HAVE DEEP STRIKE (a 3rd arrival threat). M14 mobile.	~180 *
Intercessor Squad	5	T4 W2 OC10 STICKY (Objective Secured / Wrathful Conquerors) — the objective stays his after they die. Bolt rifle volume.	80
Bladeguard Veteran Squad	5	3+/4++ OC + Teleport Homers; forward pressure / brick support.	80
Vanguard Veteran Squad (Jump)	2	OC5, M12, Teleport Homers — army-wide OC + forward homers that enable the teleport alpha.	~180 *